

Tsung-Hsien Li

📍 Institute of Economics, Academia Sinica, 128 Academia Road, Section 2, 115201 Taipei, Taiwan

🔗 <https://tsunghsien1124.github.io/>

✉ tsunghsien1124@gmail.com — thli@econ.sinica.edu.tw

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Consumer Finance, Financial Intermediation, Family Economics

Positions

- July 2023 — Assistant Research Fellow of Economics, Academia Sinica
- 2026 — 2027 Visiting Research Scholar, University of Pennsylvania
- 2022 — 2023 Max Weber Postdoctoral Fellow, European University Institute
- 2015 — 2017 Economic and Financial Analysis Specialist, Central Bank of Taiwan

Education

- 2017 — 2022 Ph.D. in Economics, University of Mannheim
- Spring 2020 Visiting Ph.D. Student, Yale University
- 2012 — 2015 M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University
- 2007 — 2012 B.A. in Economics & B.S.S. in Bio-Industry Communication and Development, National Taiwan University

Working Papers

“The Payday Loan Puzzle: A Credit Scoring Explanation,” (with Jan Sun), *Reject & Resubmit, Review of Economic Studies*

“Consumer Bankruptcy: the Role of Financial Frictions,” *Reject & Resubmit, European Economic Review*

“The Role of Marital Status for the Evaluation of Bankruptcy Regimes,” (with Jan Sun)

“Vague by Design: Central Bank Communication with an Inattentive Public” (with Federico Innocenti), *Revise & Resubmit, Macroeconomic Dynamics*

“Medical Expenditure Risk: Evidence in the MEPS 1996-2019”

“Who Provides It Matters: Source Characteristics and Trust in Online Information,” (with Giacomo Ferraro and Federico Innocenti)

Work in Progress

“Household and Expert Inflation Expectations in Regime Transitions,” (with Nan-Kuang Chen and Yi-Hsuan Chang Chien)

“Collateral Constraints, Housing Prices, and Business Cycle Fluctuations in Taiwan,” (with Nan-Kuang Chen and Cheng-Yun Chen)

Published Papers

“Credit card and payday loan borrowing: Evidence in the SCF 2010–2019,” *Economics Letters*, December 2022, Vol. 221

“Identifying and Evaluating Domestic Systemically Important Banks in Taiwan,” (in Mandarin Chinese, with Nan-Kuang Chen and Yu-Ning Hwang), *Quarterly Bulletin, Central Bank of R.O.C. (Taiwan)*, December 2017, Vol. 39(4)

Presentations

2026 — Royal Holloway, University of London (Egham), Shih Hsin University (Taipei), National Dong Hwa University (Hualien), National Sun Yat-sen University (Kaohsiung), 9th HenU/INFER Workshop on Applied Macroeconomics (Zhengzhou), Fu Jen Catholic University (New Taipei), Chung-Hua Institution for Economic Research (Taipei)

2025 — Joint Japan-Taiwan Public Economics Workshop (Taipei), National Chung Cheng University (Chiayi), National Dong Hwa University (Hualien), Annual Conference of the Population Association of Taiwan (Taipei), 5th World Congress of Taiwan Studies (WCTS) (Taipei), University of Verona (Verona), Max Weber Fellows Conference (Florence), 24th Annual Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory (SAET) Conference (Ischia), International Conference on Survey Methodology, Application, and New Developments (Taipei), 8th Lindau Nobel Meeting in Economic Sciences (Lindau), 8th HenU/INFER Workshop on Applied Macroeconomics (Kaifeng), 1st Workshop of the East and South-East Asian Macroeconomic Society (WESEAMS) (Tokyo), Microeconomics Workshop: Theory and Application (Xiamen), National Cheng Kung University (Tainan), City University of Hong Kong (Hong Kong), National Chengchi University (Taipei)

2024 — Graz Schumpeter Winter School (Graz), 1st Tokyo-Taipei-Seoul Macroeconomics Network Workshop (Tokyo), Fu Jen Catholic University (New Taipei), National Central University (Taoyuan), 7th HenU/INFER Workshop on Applied Macroeconomics (Zhengzhou), AS-NTU Young Economists Workshop (Taipei), NTU-AS Symposium on Macroeconomics and Resilience (Discussion) (Taipei), 18th International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications (Taipei), 9th CEAFFE/MWET (Rennes), National Cheng Kung University (Tainan), 6th China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM) (Hong Kong), International Society for Bayesian Analysis World Meeting (Venice), International Economic Policy in Complex Environments (EPOC) Conference (Milan), Taiwan Economics

Research (Taipei), National Chengchi University (Taipei), Kobe University (Kobe), Osaka University (Osaka), Taiwan Econometric Society Annual Conference (Taipei), Workshop of the Australasian Macroeconomics Society (WAMS) & UCSB Laboratory for Aggregate Economics and Finance (LAEF) (Perth), Deakin University (Melbourne), Econometric Society Australasian Meeting (Melbourne)

2023 — 17th Max Weber Fellows Conference (Florence), EEA-ESEM (Barcelona), 3rd SASCA Ph.D. Conference in Economics (Sassari), National Taiwan University (Taipei), National Tsing Hua University (Hsinchu), Macroeconometric Modelling Workshop (Taipei), Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics Conference (Taipei), 48th SAEe (Salamanca), Soochow University (Taipei)

2022 — 15th RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics (Online), 26th Spring Meeting of Young Economists (Orleans, France), 4th QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop (London), ENTER Jamboree (Discussion) (Barcelona), EEA-ESEM (Milan), 2nd SASCA Ph.D. Conference in Economics (Venice), 2nd Bank of Lithuania Invited Lecture Series/Conference (Vilnius), 2nd Ventotene Macro Workshop (Poster) (Ventotene), CEPR European Conference on Household Finance (Ispra), Konstanz Doctoral Workshop on Quantitative Dynamic Economics (Konstanz)

Before 2021 — Warwick Economics PhD Conference (Online), CES Annual Conference (Online), ENTER Jamboree (Online), 11th GESS Research Day (Online), TEA Annual Conference (Online), National Taipei University (Online), 46th SAEe (Barcelona), Academia Sinica (Online), Bonn-Mannheim PhD Workshop (Online)

Grants

Taiwan National Science and Technology Council (NSTC) (newly-recruited track): “The Macroeconomics Effects and Policy Implications of Consumer Finance and Default,” Oct 2023–Sep 2025 (PI, 112-2410-H-001-099-MY2)

Academia Sinica Grand Challenge Program Seed Grant: “Linking Economic Shocks to Long-Term Birthrate Decline—Revisiting Negative Education-Fertility Relationship,” Jul 2024–Jun 2026 (CO-PI, AS-GCS-113-H07)

Taiwan NSTC (newly-recruited track): “The Roots of Discrimination: An Experimental Analysis,” August 2024 - July 2025 (PI, 113-2410-H-001-059)

Taiwan NSTC (ordinary track): “On the Role of Behavioral Heterogeneity in Macroeconomics: Debt Literacy, Debt Rollover, and Misperceived Borrowing Cost,” October 2025–September 2028 (PI, 114-2410-H-001-100-MY3)

Academia Sinica Grand Challenge Program Seed Grant: “GenAI’s Democratization of Advice-Taking: Theory and Experimental Evidence,” Jan 2026–Dec 2027 (PI, AS-GCS-115-H02)

*Central Bank of the R.O.C. (Taiwan) Funded Research Project: “Heterogeneous Effects of House and Stock Price Changes on Private Consumption in Taiwan,” August 2026–July

Academic Supervision and Mentoring

EXTERNAL THESIS COMMITTEES

Shen-Hsun Liao	M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, 2023
Ta-Chun Chang	M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, 2025
Tsu-Ting Chuang	M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, 2026
Sangulukani Chilinda	M.A. in Economics, National Dong Hwa University, 2026
Mpumelelo Nzalo	M.A. in Economics, National Dong Hwa University, 2026
(tbc) Hsien-Yu Tseng	M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, 2026

MASTER'S THESIS SUPERVISION

Hui-Wen Ma	Co-advisor with Prof. Nan-Kuang Chen, M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, 2026
Shao-An Lin	Co-advisor with Prof. Nan-Kuang Chen, M.A. in Economics, National Taiwan University, in progress

RESEARCH ASSISTANT SUPERVISION AND MENTORING

Jakob Lögler	Part-time research assistant and exchange student at National Chengchi University, Spring 2026
Cheng-Yun Chen	Research assistant, 2024–2026; admitted to the MRes in Economics (Ph.D. track) at Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
Yi-Hsuan Chang Chien	Research assistant, 2025–present